



Spreading without seeds



Mint

Tiny plantlets with roots form along the fleshy leaves.



Plantlet

Underground stems can send out new shoots around the mother plant.



Iris

Spreading underground stems are partially visible through a thin layer of soil.



Beech

Stems grow from the base of the old tree.

Mother of thousands

Each leaf can produce dozens of tiny plantlets.

Some plants have evolved ways to spread quickly over an area without seeds. To do this, they make perfect copies of themselves using modified stems, forming underground storage organs, or growing baby plants on the margins of their leaves.

Plants such as **mint**, **strawberry**, and **bamboo** send out long stems, either just below or on top of the soil, which can put down roots and grow into whole new plants. The creeping underground stems, or rhizomes, of some **irises** also send up new plants as they spread. Other plants, such as **sweet potatoes**, produce underground storage